Resources Industries, Approvals

Hon. DR LAST (Burdekin—LNP) (Minister for Natural Resources and Mines, Minister for Manufacturing and Minister for Regional and Rural Development) (10.11 am): Today I will be introducing new legislation to deliver a more efficient and targeted framework for objections to mining lease applications while putting a stop to those who lob vexatious claims and intentionally use this process to frustrate or delay project approvals. Assessment requirements are currently duplicated across mining and environment legislation, resulting in unnecessary procedural steps that delay decisions for potentially years at a time, create uncertainty and increase costs for applicants, objectors and decision-makers.

We only need to look at the debacle of the long-running legal battle that the New Acland coalmine expansion experienced to understand that this process has to change. For close to 15 years the mining company and community did not have certainty on the project's future, and the former Labor government allowed this to happen. They left the community, local farmers, local council and resources workers in limbo for close to 15 years. We are changing that. No community should have to go through another New Acland experience. The bill being introduced today addresses these issues. We are replacing the automatic referral of objections to the Land Court with a more targeted and proportional referral process to reduce the number of projects held up in court. Further, the grounds for an objection will need to be based on the decision-making criteria.

I want to make this point crystal clear for those opposite. This is not about sacrificing environmental conditions; it is about finding the balance between upholding our strong environmental standards, listening to the concerns of affected persons and local communities, and enhancing Queensland's investment attractiveness. It is about amending the objections process by granting objection rights to the people who are directly affected by a proposed mining project—local farmers, landholders, community members and local government. It means activists, who are often based thousands of kilometres away, and green groups, many funded by foreign overseas entities, are no longer eligible to have a say.

Using the Land Court to hold up a mining project does not serve anyone. It does not serve the local farmer who wants to know if a mine is going to be built down the road, it does not serve the local government needing to plan for infrastructure, and it does not serve Queensland workers who are waiting for a job in the mining industry. We made a commitment that we would streamline approvals, restore confidence and provide certainty—certainty for proponents, communities, local landholders, businesses and workers. It is about getting to a 'yes' or a 'no' faster, and we are doing just that.

Hospital Infrastructure

Hon. TJ NICHOLLS (Clayfield—LNP) (Minister for Health and Ambulance Services) (10.14 am): The Crisafulli government is delivering for Queensland, with our fully funded Hospital Rescue Plan powering ahead. Cranes are swinging, piling rigs are drilling—'drill, baby, drill', which is the new motto for the health infrastructure department, thank you—thousands of construction workers are on worksites across the state, and productivity is up because there is no CFMEU BPIC.

Mr Bleijie: He rolled his eyes.

Mr NICHOLLS: Exactly. Since the budget in June we have announced that CPB and Hansen Yuncken will deliver the next stage of the Cairns Hospital expansion, including a new helipad and the health innovation and surgical centre, with more operating theatres and more beds by 2031 and a new 1,000-space car park. That is on top of the 32 beds we opened in Cairns in August and the 32 more coming next year. We have released the new hospital masterplan for the Mackay Base Hospital that will deliver 128 new beds and 1,000 more car parks. Major contractors are now engaged to deliver the next stages of the bigger and better Redcliffe, Coomera and Bundaberg hospitals. These projects will deliver almost 1,000 new beds for Queenslanders, which is 265 more than was going to be delivered under Labor's failed capacity expansion program.

We have also announced a new eight-bed perinatal mental health unit at the Nambour General Hospital, we have opened the new 32-bed adult mental health unit in Rockhampton, and we have delivered new birthing suites in Biloela with additional staffing options. Across the state, the Crisafulli government is getting on with delivering more hospital beds for Queensland.

Talking about Biloela, I am pleased to inform the House that yesterday the Crisafulli government restored birthing services in Biloela, and Cooktown, I might say. These services languished for years under Labor—for almost 1,000 days in Cooktown and almost 800 days in Biloela. Queenslanders voted

for a fresh start and this is exactly what we are delivering. In fact, I am pleased to advise the House that at 2.11 am today we had our first birth in Biloela—a fresh start for Biloela. What are the naysayers, doubters and do-nothings saying now? There he is—another blunder by the member for Miller, another fail by the member for Miller.

Mr BAILEY: Mr Acting Speaker, I rise to a point of order. Clearly I take personal offence and ask the minister to withdraw.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Minister for Health, will you withdraw, please?

Mr NICHOLLS: I withdraw. What about all the naysayers and doubters out there who said it would not happen? Let me say this to Bronwyn and Benn: congratulations on the birth of your new baby and congratulations on being the first to use the fully restored birthing suite in Biloela, funded by the Crisafulli government. Birthing in Bilo meant this family did not need to travel the 300-kilometre round trip to Rockhampton. In fact, they are now back at home in Orange Creek, 15 minutes away. That is the choice—

Mr Bleijie: And they named their baby Tim.

Mr NICHOLLS: They may well have, but I will not go there. Their travel was 15 minutes and 20 kilometres, as opposed to three hours and 300 kilometres. That is delivering services. Bronwyn was supported by amazing midwives Toni and Rhianna. How amazing is it that a midwifery student, Emma, had the opportunity to also be in the room, because we are delivering more staff in more places? I give a big shout-out to the member for Callide, Bryson Head, for his advocacy. We said we would restore birthing services in Biloela and Cooktown. We have delivered what we said we would, despite the naysayers. Labor closes birthing services; the LNP government opens birthing services.

Bushfires, Preparedness

Hon. A LEAHY (Warrego—LNP) (Minister for Local Government and Water and Minister for Fire, Disaster Recovery and Volunteers) (10.19 am): As Queensland—

Ho**nourable members** interjected.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Order, members.

Honourable members interjected.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Member for Miller, member for Clayfield, cease your quarrelling. We are not going to start that way today.

Ms LEAHY: As Queensland enters the higher risk bushfire season we have seen our frontline firies jump into action for what forecasts indicate will be a busy season. The first weekend of our season saw our volunteer and paid firies respond to 184 bushfire incidents with 420 resources across Queensland. Knowing the risk ahead, we have been helping our firies prepare during a record amount of work and preparation for this season.

When it comes to fire mitigation on state lands this year, there has been a 74 per cent increase on Labor's last year in government. Private landholders have also done a record amount of fire mitigation this year, a 45 per cent increase on Labor's last year in government. The former Labor government was going in the wrong direction. They proposed to cut 40 specialist fire rangers from the Queensland Parks and Wildlife Service in their final budget. The work we have done has only been possible because we are making fire mitigation a priority.

We have also been empowering our volunteer firies to get on with the job. We have increased the number of fire trucks being delivered by over 400 per cent on Labor's last year in government. We have built new sheds across the state and we will continue to do so. We have reversed Labor's decision to take interest from brigade bank accounts. We are ensuring firies have access to the most comprehensive firefighter workers compensation with a budget allocation of $15.7 million per annum. We have amended the legislation to empower rural fire brigades to act on their own accord. Because our firies do so much, they deserve our backing, and back them we will.

We also want to acknowledge that tomorrow is Yellow Ribbon Day. We will stand here with the RFBAQ and say thank you to our rural firies across the state. To all our firies who have been preparing over the past months, to those who have already been called out and to those who will give their time over the coming months to keep our community safe, the Crisafulli government and I say thank you for all that you do.

ABSENCE OF MINISTER

Dr ROWAN (Moggill—LNP) (Leader of the House) (10.21 am): I advise that, as the Minister for Families, Seniors and Disability Services and Minister for Child Safety and the Prevention of Domestic and Family Violence will be absent for this week's sitting, the Minister for Local Government and Water and Minister for Fire, Disaster Recovery and Volunteers will answer questions for the minister in question time this week.

LEAVE TO MOVE MOTION

Hon. SJ MILES (Murrumba—ALP) (Leader of the Opposition) (10.22 am): I seek leave to move general business notice of motion No. 1 standing in my name.

Division: Question put—That leave be granted.

In division—

Honourable members interjected.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Order, members.

Honourable members interjected.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Attorney-General, member for Pine Rivers and other members who like to quarrel, please cease.

AYES, 34:

ALP, 32—Asif, Bailey, Bourne, Boyd, Bush, Butcher, de Brenni, Dick, Farmer, Furner, Grace, Howard, J. Kelly, Linard, Martin, McCallum, McMahon, McMillan, Mellish, Miles, Mullen, Nightingale, O'Shea, Pease, Power, Pugh, Richmond, Russo, Ryan, Scanlon, Smith, Whiting.

Grn, 1—Berkman.

Ind, 1—Bolton.

NOES, 49:

LNP, 49—Baillie, Barounis, Bates, Bennett, Bleijie, Boothman, Chiesa, Crandon, Crisafulli, Dalton, Dillon, Doolan, Dooley, Field, Frecklington, Gerber, Hatcher, Head, Hutton, Hunt, B. James, T. James, Janetzki, G. Kelly, Kempton, Kirkland, Langbroek, Last, Leahy, Lee, Lister, Mander, Marr, McDonald, Mickelberg, Minnikin, Molhoek, Nicholls, O'Connor, Perrett, Poole, Powell, Purdie, Rowan, Simpson, Stevens, Stoker, Vorster, Young.

Pair: Camm, Enoch.

Resolved in the negative.

QUESTIONS WITHOUT NOTICE

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: I advise that question time today will conclude at 11.27 am.

Ambulance Service

Mr MILES (10.27 am): My question is to the Minister for Health. Olympic skateboarding coach Patrick Gemzik and his mum join us in the gallery today. In March Patrick experienced a 36-hour ordeal which resulted in brain damage and irreversible damage to his eyesight. Can the minister advise why Patrick waited four hours for an ambulance that never arrived?

Mr NICHOLLS: I thank the Leader of the Opposition for his question. Of course, I welcome consumers of our medical services into the gallery here today.

Honourable members interjected.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: Order, members.

Mr NICHOLLS: I welcome them to the gallery today and, of course, this is the place for those sorts of questions to be asked. As always, I am happy to address those issues. I am unfamiliar with the particular details of the matter that has been raised by the Leader of the Opposition. I am happy to investigate those details if they have not already been referred through my office to the appropriate hospital and health service for response. Inevitably, that is the course of action when we receive correspondence from those people who contact our office: we pass that on to the hospital and health

service for response and to address that issue. As always, if there are instances where the service fails to deliver what it ought to deliver and there are reasons for that, we investigate and attempt to improve the service, as you would always expect us to do.

More than 1.6 million consumers a year enter our emergency departments. Despite the best efforts of our hardworking staff—the triage nurses and the clinicians who are there—there are occasions when it does not work perfectly, and that is regretted. That is why we always take the opportunity to investigate, to review and to deliver better services.

Mr Bleijie: Did they refer it to your office? How long have you had this? Did you refer it to the minister's office?

Mr NICHOLLS: In respect of that, I am absolutely happy to investigate the details if I am unaware of them. Obviously in instances where the results are unsatisfactory or they are as has been described by the Leader of the Opposition, I extend my sympathies and my condolences. We do everything we can to provide support to patients in those circumstances to ensure that where possible the support that is necessary is provided. I am very happy to extend that offer again today.

That is also why we are investing in new hospitals. That is why we have put more than a billion dollars into the Queensland Ambulance Service to deliver 200 more vehicles and to deliver 230 more ambulance officers—paramedics—throughout the state in order to be able to respond more quickly, because it is in fact the person in the community that the Ambulance Service does not have visibility of who is of most concern to us. So, Leader of the Opposition, I am absolutely prepared and happy to investigate that further and offer my condolences to the people in the chamber whom you have brought along today.

Health System

Mr MILES: My question is to the Minister for Health. After Patrick's parents drove him to Redland Hospital he was transferred by ambulance to the PA Hospital, where there was no bed available for him. I table a document released to the family which shows that the PA Hospital told Redland that Patrick should not be sent.

Tabled paper: Document, dated 19 March 2026, titled 'Progress Notes' [1605].

Can the minister advise why Patrick was sent to the PA Hospital against advice?

Mr NICHOLLS: Obviously I have not had an opportunity to peruse the document that has been tabled. As I have indicated to the Leader of the Opposition, I am personally unaware of the circumstances in relation to this. If it has been referred to my office—and it may well have been—my office will no doubt have passed that on to the appropriate person—usually the chief executive of Metro South—for investigation, for response and for advice. That is our invariable practice within 24 hours. I believe, if my office is aware of it, that that would have occurred.

I cannot explain or answer for decisions made operationally on the ground by our staff in these circumstances. What I can say in relation to the PA Hospital is that the construction of the additional beds at the PA Hospital is now running ahead of schedule so that the Hospital Rescue Plan that we have put in place will deliver more beds at the PA Hospital. It will also repair—fix—the issues that have been discovered there, including the failure to ensure that the fire suppression system in the PA Hospital is satisfactory, and we have had to invest more money to fix 10 years of maintenance failure in respect of that. We have had to invest more money in the heating, ventilation and air-conditioning systems because none of those had been repaired for a decade. We are also investing in a new kitchen so that the people who are at the PA Hospital receiving care receive the meals that they need from a properly functioning kitchen, which again, upon investigation, had not been properly maintained.

As I said to the Leader of the Opposition—and I extend the offer to the family who are here today—I am more than happy to investigate and to respond and if there have been failures in the delivery of healthcare services they will be addressed, as they always are. However, I want to emphasise: none of the people who go to work for Queensland Health in our emergency departments go there other than with the best of intentions to deliver services. All of them—even on their toughest days—go to work, front up and make the effort to care for those 1.6 million people who come through the doors every year in our hospital service.

The fact that there are not enough beds because there are a thousand stranded Australians taking up beds in our hospitals—the PA is one of them, as is Redlands, which is another one where the Premier and I launched the 'stranded Australians' program—is not the fault of those doctors and nurses and nor is it the fault of the people who expect care. Rather, it is the fault of a federal government that

The program provides for the completion of important legislation concerning Queensland's container refund scheme, the government's Circuit Breaker youth justice reforms and also matters pertaining to road safety. The time allocated provides members with meaningful opportunities to contribute, examine the proposed reforms and address matters identified throughout the parliamentary process.

The motion also provides, in accordance with standing order 172, for the Transport and Other Legislation Amendment Bill and the Criminal Code (Dangerous Driving) and Other Legislation Amendment Bill to be treated as cognate bills for their remaining stages. Without pre-empting the substantive debate on these bills, it is appropriate to briefly explain why their cognate consideration is sensible and pragmatic.

The bills form complementary parts of the government's broader road safety reform agenda and address closely connected issues involving dangerous and unlawful conduct on Queensland roads. The Criminal Code bill proposes to modernise Queensland's dangerous-driving framework and strengthen the consequences for serious and aggravated offending. The transport bill addresses associated road safety matters including drink and drug driving, combined drink and drug driving, extreme speeding and seatbelt offences. There is a clear relationship between the subject matter of the bills.

Considering the bills together will allow members to address these concurrent and overlapping issues comprehensively. It will avoid unnecessary repetition while providing members with a proper opportunity to examine the distinct provisions and policy objectives of each bill. The bills were introduced on the same day, referred to the same parliamentary committee and considered concurrently throughout the committee inquiry process, so a cognate debate is logical when it comes to those matters.

This motion will also facilitate the moving by the Leader of the House of motions relating to the same question rule following matters of public interest today. These are straightforward procedural motions which will provide members with clarity and certainty about the consideration of those matters.

The government legislation listed in this motion is, of course, only part of the important business before the House. There are also matters of public interest and private members' statements. Also, the member for Nudgee will move a disallowance motion later on. The business program motion, therefore, strikes an appropriate balance. It preserves meaningful opportunities for members to contribute while ensuring the House can consider and determine the business before it.

In concluding, I also acknowledge the Dickies, who are in the gallery—Geoff and Priscilla Dickie, as well as Allison Baden-Clay's sister, Vanessa Fowler. It was a pleasure to attend a recent event with them in Brookfield, along with Councillor Greg Adermann. I commend the motion to the House.

Hon. DE FARMER (Bulimba—ALP) (11.36 am): The opposition opposes this motion. Quite frankly, on the International Day of Democracy it is outrageous that the Leader of the House should be proposing such a motion stifling democracy. If ever there was a place where we should be seeing democracy in action, it is this place—it is this parliament where there should be ample and healthy debate on every bill amongst members of parliament who have been elected by Queenslanders across this state, where laws are introduced and amply debated, where there is time for inquiry, where laws can be refined through debate and amendment and where they are all the better for the democratic process. I think that is what Queenslanders expect of us, but they would be shocked if they knew how many times the Leader of the House has stood up to propose that debate be truncated on important bills, that there be no consideration in detail so they cannot be interrogated and amendments cannot be made. If they actually knew that this happens every single sitting week on every single bill, they would be absolutely shocked.

From the Premier who said, 'Let the sun shine in,' what in fact is happening is that we are keeping the sunshine out in this state. On almost every single bill there is almost no consideration in detail whatsoever. I am not going to speak on all of the other bills that the Leader of the House just talked us through for which there will be very little debate. Each of those laws is absolutely critical to the Queenslanders to whom they apply. What I can talk about is the youth crime bill and, in this instance, it is the Circuit Breaker bill. This happens on every single one of the youth crime bills. I can attest to that because the Circuit Breaker bill is the fifth youth crime bill we have seen, and we already have a sixth one on the table. It is a default position that we should limit debate on them, that we should limit inquiry on them.

Government members interjected.

Madam DEPUTY SPEAKER (Ms Marr): Members to my right!

Ms FARMER: We all know why they are limiting consideration in detail on these bills. We all know why the Minister for Youth Justice and Victim Support does not want too much debate on them. It is because youth crime is the topic that they made really big promises on before the election. In fact, the Premier staked his leadership on it, so they are absolutely desperate to look good on that and to look like they are taking action. They have their fancy slogans. Each bill is named with a fancy slogan or a set of rhyming words. The cold, plain, hard facts are that their youth crime laws are just not working. Despite all the fudging of figures, what we know from QPS figures is that the number of offences being committed has actually increased by 6.15 per cent in 2026.

They have nowhere else to go on their youth crime laws. We have had one youth crime law after another. First, youth crime was going to be down by the first Christmas after they were elected. Then it was going to take a bit longer. Then we were going to have green shoots. Then we had another piece of legislation brought in. They rig all the questions, go around doing the media and paying for all that government advertising, then they bring in another law, then it is advertised and lots of money is spent telling Queenslanders that everything is working. Madam Deputy Speaker Marr, you only have to go out into your community in particular. You and your fellow members in Far North Queensland are hearing it and we are seeing it on your social media. We see it in every single one of our Facebook community groups.

This minister and this government are desperate to keep on introducing laws so it will look like there is some action being taken, but with every single law Queenslanders are seeing it more and more and they are feeling it. It is their daily experience that those laws are not working, so this minister needs to ensure there is no debate. This minister needs to ensure there is no consideration in detail. This minister needs to ensure there is limited time for debate because she does not want us to ask the tricky questions. We oppose this motion; we support democracy. Let's put it in action this week.

Madam DEPUTY SPEAKER (Ms Marr): Before I call the member for Mundingburra, I want to remind those members who are on a warning. They are the members for Logan, Miller and Lytton.

Mrs POOLE (Mundingburra—LNP) (11.41 am): I rise in support of the business program motion moved by the Leader of the House. Yes, today is a day of democracy and every voice counts, and this motion supports that. This is about every voice. Yes, we have introduced a number of tranches in relation to Adult Crime, Adult Time. We came into this chamber on the back of Queensland voting for a fresh start. We said that everything we do will be about making Queensland safer, so we are strengthening laws, introducing consequences for actions and putting the rights of victims before the rights of offenders. We have consistently proven that. Every single thing we have done has been about strengthening laws. I would ask the member for Bulimba and those opposite how they are going to vote for the circuit breaker bill. How are you going to vote on Breach Bail, Go to Jail?

Ms GRACE: Madam Deputy Speaker, I rise to a point of order on relevance. This is a procedural motion, not an opportunity to debate the motion.

Madam DEPUTY SPEAKER: Member for Mundingburra, that is a point of order I am going to accept. If you could bring it back to the motion, thank you.

Mrs POOLE: This motion is about giving people a voice. This motion is about when debates conclude and when the House makes decisions—

Mr McDonald: Calm and methodical government.

Mrs POOLE: I will take that interjection. It is about a government that is calmly and methodically delivering for Queensland and it is about balance. Everything we do is simply to provide for the orderly management of the business of this House, which is what the people of Queensland have been crying out for for 10 years. After a decade of decline and chaos under the former Labor government, they now have a government that is calm, methodical and balanced. Everything that we—

Ms GRACE: Madam Deputy Speaker, I rise to a point of order on relevance.

Dr ROWAN: Madam Deputy Speaker, I rise to a point of order. My point of order is in relation to the point of order from the member for McConnel and is that the member for Mundingburra is being relevant. She is providing context as to the reasons within the procedural motion this government each and every week under its business program motion takes a calm and methodical approach to outline for all members the business program for the week, which includes the legislation, the ability to make speeches and other bits and pieces—

Ms Grace: You never said that.

Dr ROWAN: I hear the member for McConnel interjecting. They do not like the 10 years of decline under the former Labor government—

Madam DEPUTY SPEAKER (Ms Marr): Member for Moggill, please take your seat. The time allocated for this debate has expired.

Division: Question put—That the motion be agreed to.

In division—

Mr de BRENNI: Mr Acting Speaker, I rise to a point of order. I draw your attention to the standing and sessional orders, which both set out the provisions for the business program motion and also the word limit on motions to be considered by the House. I draw your attention to the standing orders, which set down the maximum word limit usually applied to motions for which notice has been given. I also draw your attention to a long series of rulings by Speakers that that also applies to motions given without notice. As this motion is without notice under sessional order 3A, I submit to you that consideration should be given to whether or not the motion before the House exceeds the word limit applied in previous Speakers' rulings.

Mr ACTING SPEAKER: I have sought advice from the Deputy Clerk. I am not going to make a ruling on your point of order right now; I am going to put the motion. I undertake to come back to you and the House with a decision on your point of order once we have had time to fully consider it.

AYES, 49:

LNP, 49—Baillie, Barounis, Bates, Bennett, Bleijie, Boothman, Chiesa, Crandon, Crisafulli, Dalton, Dillon, Doolan, Dooley, Field, Frecklington, Gerber, Hatcher, Head, Hutton, Hunt, B. James, T. James, Janetzki, G. Kelly, Kempton, Kirkland, Langbroek, Last, Leahy, Lee, Lister, Mander, Marr, McDonald, Mickelberg, Minnikin, Molhoek, Nicholls, O'Connor, Perrett, Poole, Powell, Purdie, Rowan, Simpson, Stevens, Stoker, Vorster, Young.

NOES, 33:

ALP, 32—Asif, Bailey, Bourne, Boyd, Bush, Butcher, de Brenni, Dick, Farmer, Furner, Grace, Howard, J. Kelly, Linard, Martin, McCallum, McMahon, McMillan, Mellish, Miles, Mullen, Nightingale, O'Shea, Pease, Power, Pugh, Richmond, Russo, Ryan, Scanlon, Smith, Whiting.

Grn, 1—Berkman.

Pair: Camm, Enoch

Resolved in the affirmative.

PROTECTING QUEENSLANDERS FROM DANGEROUS PRISONERS AND STRENGTHENING VICTIMS' RIGHTS AMENDMENT BILL

Introduction

Hon. LJ GERBER (Currumbin—LNP) (Minister for Youth Justice and Victim Support and Minister for Corrective Services) (11.51 am): I present a bill for an act to amend the Corrective Services Act 2006, the Victims' Commissioner and Sexual Violence Review Board Act 2024 and the Youth Justice Act 1992 for particular purposes. I table the bill, the explanatory notes and a statement of compatibility with human rights. I also table a statement of exceptional circumstances. I nominate the Justice, Integrity and Community Safety Committee to consider the bill.

Tabled paper: Protecting Queenslanders from Dangerous Prisoners and Strengthening Victims' Rights Amendment Bill 2026 [1606].

Tabled paper: Protecting Queenslanders from Dangerous Prisoners and Strengthening Victims' Rights Amendment Bill 2026, explanatory notes [1607].

Tabled paper: Protecting Queenslanders from Dangerous Prisoners and Strengthening Victims' Rights Amendment Bill 2026, statement of compatibility with human rights [1608].

Tabled paper: Protecting Queenslanders from Dangerous Prisoners and Strengthening Victims' Rights Amendment Bill 2026, statement of exceptional circumstances [1609].

The Protecting Queenslanders from Dangerous Prisoners and Strengthening Victims' Rights Amendment Bill 2026 delivers major reforms to Queensland's parole system to keep the state's most dangerous offenders behind bars longer, to strengthen community safety and to put the rights of victims

first. A strong parole system must protect the community, give victims confidence that their safety comes first and safely manage offenders as they transition from custody back into the community, because that is what parole should do: safeguard the community.

That makes parole decisions some of the most consequential decisions in the justice system. They determine whether a prisoner remains behind bars or is permitted to serve the remainder of their sentence in the community with supervision and enforceable conditions. For victims and their families, those decisions carry great significance. That is why Queenslanders rightly expect a parole system that recognises the gravity of parole—that it is a privilege, not a right—and that is why any decision regarding parole must properly assess risk, put community safety first and put the rights of victims and their families before the rights of offenders. For too long, Queensland's parole system fell short of these standards.

In 1987 Sian Kingi was abducted, tortured, sexually assaulted and brutally murdered. She was just 12 years old—a daughter, a sister, a young girl who should have had her whole life ahead of her. One of her killers, Barrie Watts, was sentenced to life imprisonment. However, decades later, Sian's family was forced to confront something no family who has endured such an unimaginable loss should ever have to face—the prospect that the man responsible for taking their daughter's life might not serve his whole life sentence—so they fought to keep him behind bars. In doing so, their fight became something much bigger: a fight to change the law so that life means life, to give families like theirs greater certainty that they would not be forced to relive that same trauma time and again.

It took the LNP member for Ninderry's, Dan Purdie, the current police minister, bringing their fight into this parliament to see any action. In 2021 the member for Ninderry tabled a petition signed by more than 72,000 people demanding stronger laws to keep prisoners like Sian's murderer behind bars. The Labor government at the time were dragged into drafting restricted prisoner laws, but they did the bare minimum and continued to prioritise prisoners. Despite overwhelming community response that life should mean life, Labor limited the framework to only a narrow group of life-sentenced prisoners: child killers and multiple murderers.

That meant that life could not mean life for hundreds of murderers sentenced to life imprisonment. Under Labor's narrow laws, life did not mean life for families like Allison Baden-Clay's. Allison was 43, and her family are here in the gallery today. She was a daughter to Geoff and Priscilla, a sister to Vanessa and Ashley, and, most importantly, a mum to three young girls. In April 2012 she was murdered by her husband, Gerard Baden-Clay. The next morning, he reported his wife missing. When police noticed scratches on his face, he deceived them and claimed he had cut himself shaving. While he covered up his actions, Allison's family waited, for 10 agonising days, while hundreds of police and SES volunteers searched day and night for her. Gerard Baden-Clay even joined in on the pretence—driving the streets of Brookfield, acting as though he too was looking for her—but he knew that Allison was never coming home.

Ten days after she disappeared, Allison's body was found 13 kilometres from her home. What followed compounded the cruelty. Gerard Baden-Clay continued to deny what he had done. He persisted with his deception. He perpetuated suggestions that Allison's mental health may have explained her disappearance. He forced the people who loved Allison through a trial where they had to listen to the woman they knew—their daughter, their sister, their mother—being diminished in an attempt to explain away her murder.

The judge who oversaw the trial condemned Gerard Baden-Clay's behaviour. He described his treatment of Allison's memory as reprehensible. He spoke of the grave impact on her family and of the three young girls who had their devoted and loving mother taken from them. Critically, he warned that whatever Baden-Clay might one day say in an application for parole would need to be treated with considerable scepticism.

After two long years, a jury found Gerard Baden-Clay guilty of Allison's murder and he was sentenced to life imprisonment, but for Allison's family a life sentence could never give them back what they had lost. Geoff and Priscilla lost their daughter, Vanessa and Ashley lost their sister and three young girls were left to grow up without their mum. After all they had been through, they deserved the certainty that a life sentence would be treated with the gravity those words carry. However, when the restricted prisoner framework was introduced, Allison's family was left outside it. Gerard Baden-Clay becomes eligible for parole next year. This bill fixes that failure.

Allison's family is not alone. Kelly Wilkinson was just 27 years old—a daughter, a sister to Danielle, who is also here today in the gallery, and a mum to three young children. In the weeks before her death, Kelly was trying to escape a relationship she feared. She had separated from her husband,

Ms ASIF: One can confidently assume that this will lead to rate increases. The minister says to this House that this is our legislation. This is not what we regulated.

Mr Powell: It is.

Ms ASIF: If it is then why are you voting against this? If the LNP minister is so adamant that nothing is changing, why are you not supporting this disallowance motion—because you want to put a bin tax on Queenslanders! It is nice and simple.

Government members interjected.

Mr DEPUTY SPEAKER (Mr McDonald): Order, members. Member for Sandgate, direct your comments through the chair, please.

Ms ASIF: The minister is now collecting the bin tax. He is going to raise it and then tell Queenslanders that it is not a tax increase. Sandgate is in a metro zone, which means under this regulation the cost will go up significantly, up to seven per cent a year—well over Treasury's indexation rate. In regional Queensland the cost will be indexed, so why not in metro areas? South-East Queensland households will be paying far more and those costs will be covered by households in our electorate. The Local Government Association of Queensland said as much after the budget. They said—

The State Budget is putting more waste levy pressures on ratepayers—while delivering a projected revenue windfall to the government of $569.7 million over four years.

It is just another way that this LNP government is looking to cover their budget black hole. They have now received a credit downgrade, for the first time in 17 years in Queensland. This is happening under an LNP government. Year on year we are going backwards. The LNP are bad at managing the economy. They are bad economic managers. That is why we have seen this credit downgrade, which means that Queensland will now have to pay more in interest. It means that money is not going towards vital services in our community—towards health care, towards school upgrades in my local community—

Mr POWELL: Mr Deputy Speaker, I rise to a point of order: relevance.

Ms ASIF: It is absolutely relevant!

Mr DEPUTY SPEAKER: Member for Sandgate, you will wait for my ruling. Thank you. You can take your seat, please. Member for Sandgate, please remain relevant to the disallowance motion. Continue.

Ms ASIF: I am very happy to, Mr Deputy Speaker. I am talking about the revenue that the government will be raising through this bin tax. This is money they are raising to fill their budget black hole, but the government does not have the right priorities—the priority to invest in our community, to invest in things that are going to make a difference in people's lives and to help our hip-pocket expenses.

While the government are happy to collect more revenue, they have been remarkably quiet about what they intend to do with that money. That is exactly why we are raising concerns about this. The government are going to use this revenue to fill their budget black hole and not reinvest into our community where it is so needed—in communities like mine where we have Dowse Lagoon and Third Lagoon. It is a beautiful part of our ecosystem. We need to ensure we are investing in our ecosystems and the environment so we can protect the species that exist there. That is where this money should be going. The department's website has now changed to say that this money is not going to be reinvested in those programs. They have removed any reference to that to say maybe some of it will be invested in those programs.

Ms Pease: The minister thinks that is funny.

Ms ASIF: I take that interjection: the minister thinks that is funny.

Mr POWELL: Mr Deputy Speaker, I rise to a point of order. I take personal offence at the statement made by the member for Sandgate and ask that she withdraw.

Mr DEPUTY SPEAKER: The member has taken personal offence. I ask you to withdraw.

Ms ASIF: I withdraw.

Government members interjected.

Mr DEPUTY SPEAKER: Order, members! The member for Sandgate has the call.

Ms ASIF: I doubt very much that any of this money is going to go back into our community to preserve the environment and ecosystem on the north side. Like I said, Dowse Lagoon at Sandgate and Third Lagoon at Brighton are both listed as part of the Moreton Bay Ramsar site. They are wetlands of significant importance in our ecosystem. Those sites support more than 50,000 waterbirds and at least 43 species of shorebirds. The site is registered on the East Asian-Australasian Flyway. Birds land on our mudflats having flown from as far as Alaska. One of them is the eastern curlew, which is critically endangered. This is why it is so important to reinvest this money into programs that will look after those endangered species.

The government is taking more and building less. This goes to why these clauses were written in. In June the Treasurer handed down the budget and very quickly the department's website was changed to remove any reference to the 70 per cent that would be put back into those programs. We know that the credit downgrade has also come after reading this same budget. That goes to show how badly the government has managed Queensland's economy and our future trajectory. When the minister continues to tell this House that nothing is changing and that this was Labor's plan, that this was Labor's trajectory, it could not be further from the truth. Labor did not have a bin tax. This is a government that has record debt, which is going to go up to over $200 billion. It is record debt—higher than any other state.

This government has done nothing for our community. They are looking to the government. They say they are struggling and they want help, but all this government can do is think of more taxes to put on the people of Queensland. If the minister is right and nothing has changed, he loses nothing by supporting this motion—so support it then. If you vote against this you are telling Queensland households that you have changed it and you are imposing a bin tax on Queensland, so every one of them can open their next rates notice and say thank you to the LNP government for the new bin tax.

Hon. AC POWELL (Glass House—LNP) (Minister for the Environment and Tourism and Minister for Science and Innovation) (5.39 pm): You have to have a hide. Referring to the member's last statement, Mr Deputy Speaker McDonald, I am seriously thinking of writing to the Speaker on the grounds that the member for Sandgate has deliberately misled this House.

I believe the member for Sandgate just said that Labor did not have a bin tax. Labor introduced the waste levy in 2019. The levy is a Labor bin tax. Labor designed the system. Labor set it all in motion. They claimed that the whole reason they were doing it was to ensure we could improve recycling rates and reuse rates in this state, but it went backwards as well. It went from 32 per cent back to 28 per cent. The infrastructure that Queensland needed to keep more waste out of landfill simply did not keep pace. That is their record.

Now those opposite come into this House seeking to disallow clauses 4 and 7—the provisions that set out future metropolitan waste levy rates. Let's have the debate, but let's have it on the facts. For the past two years we have been working very hard to clean up the mess we inherited. Unlike those opposite, we are not looking at one part of the waste system—a waste system they implemented, by the way—in isolation. We are reforming the settings. We are backing councils. We are investing in infrastructure. Those opposite did not. They can wave around a policy, but the only infrastructure those opposite invested in was the weighbridges councils used to calculate the tonnage of waste going to landfill so they could pay the then Labor government the waste levy. The only other thing those opposite invested in were regional waste management plans. They did not actually change anything. They are documents sitting on most regional councils' shelves. We are instead backing councils. We are investing in infrastructure and—

Ms Linard: Like what?

Mr POWELL: I will take the member's interjection. I will get to that; give me a moment. We are giving industry the certainty to invest. This motion is targeted. It seeks to disallow clauses 4 and 7, which provide for the level 1 metropolitan levy rate to be prescribed for the four years from 2026-27 through to 2029-30. Clause 7 sets those levy rates. This is not some new waste levy. As I said, Labor introduced it back in 2019. Nor did the $10-a-year trajectory suddenly appear under this government. That trajectory has been in place since 2022. We have provided certainty for the next four years for councils, waste operators, recyclers and businesses considering investing in Queensland's resource recovery industry.

The purpose of the levy is straightforward. If waste goes to landfill the levy applies; if it is recycled it does not. It is meant to make recycling more competitive with landfill. It did not under Labor; it went backwards. We became the second worst recycler in the country. Weakening the signal is not the answer. Those opposite will say the metropolitan rate was supposed to return to indexation. We heard that argument at estimates. They pointed to an old government website, but there is a very simple problem with that argument: they were the government. Governments do not legislate through websites; they legislate through legislation. Their regulation only prescribed levy rates through to 2025-26. There was no legislated metropolitan rate for 2026-27 or beyond. There was no legislated return to indexation from 2028-29. They can point to an old website all they like, but show me the regulation. They had the pen. They could have put it in; they did not. Our evidence is what they legislated. The $10-a-year metropolitan trajectory has applied since 2022, and we will continue giving everyone certainty for another four years.

We heard a lot from those opposite about councils, so let's deal with that too because the levy rate is only one side of the equation. The government has separately set annual payment arrangements to help councils offset levy costs associated with household waste. Across the next four years councils are being provided $488 million in annual payments. In fact, they have been provided that either side of the end of the last financial year. We have adjusted those payments to align with the targets in our new waste strategy. We have upped something, and it is the targets. For metropolitan councils, Labor would have had them reducing progressively to 20 per cent. We are reducing it to 30 per cent. For major regional councils—they were on the same trajectory as the metropolitan councils—we made a deliberate decision to set a higher end point of 50 per cent. Other eligible regional councils retain their 100 per cent cover. That change means that regional councils are around $8.6 million better off than they would have been under the former Labor government. Importantly, let me be clear, that is not what clauses 4 and 7 do. Those payment arrangements are not—

Ms Linard interjected.

Ms Boyd interjected.

Mr DEPUTY SPEAKER (Mr McDonald): One moment, member for Glass House. Member for Nudgee and member for Pine Rivers, you have both had your say. Your interjections are not being taken. If you continue to disrupt the House I will warn you.

Mr POWELL: As I said, those payment arrangements are not what this motion seeks to disallow, but they matter to this debate because they expose just how selective Labor's argument is. They want to talk about the levy in isolation whereas we look at the whole system. When it comes to giving major regional councils greater ongoing cover, those opposite had the opportunity when they were in government. They did not do it; we did.

Even then, annual payments are not the long-term solution. Our objective is to not have councils sending the same amount of waste to landfill forever and governments endlessly compensating them for it. We want councils paying less levy because they are sending less waste to landfill. That is the change Queensland needs. To the member for Nudgee's point, that requires infrastructure—something the previous government did not invest in. You cannot simply tell people to recycle more if there is nowhere for the material to go. You need sorting infrastructure, you need processing capacity, you need organics facilities, you need markets for recycled materials, and in regional Queensland you also need to overcome distance.

That is why our new waste strategy is backed by almost $1 billion over five years. This is not another plan without delivery—this is real investment, real projects and real infrastructure. As a number of members on this side have mentioned, the Resource Recovery Boost Fund, something those opposite did not have, is now worth $170 million. We initially committed $130 million. In this year's budget we added another $40 million because councils came forward with practical projects and we wanted to get more of them moving.

The member for Nudgee asked what we have invested in. The first round backed in 26 council projects right across this state: on the Gold Coast we have expanded organics processing; better resource recovery in Nudgee, the member's own electorate; new infrastructure at Logan Village; increased processing and recovery facilities in Townsville; and projects in Gympie, Noosa, Barcaldine, metro councils and regional councils. There are different projects but one goal: to keep material out of landfill.

Mr Nicholls: Anything in Clayfield?

Mr POWELL: It is next to Nudgee, member for Clayfield. Importantly, those first-round projects are expected to divert more than 150,000 tonnes a year and save councils around $17 million each and every year in levy costs once operational. That is particularly relevant to this motion because in the metropolitan zone, first-round Resource Recovery Boost Fund projects are expected to deliver around $27 million in levy savings across the 2028-29 and 2029-30 financial years. That is more than the estimated $18 million impact of the levy over those two years. That is the part of this debate those opposite conveniently leave out. We are not just setting the price signal; we are investing to help councils respond to it.

Then there is organic waste. Through GROW FOGO we are investing $45 million to help councils introduce or expand green-lid bin services. Those projects are expected to divert more than 100,000 tonnes of organic waste from landfill each year and save councils around $30 million a year in levy costs. If you put that alongside the first round of the Resource Recover Boost Fund, we are talking about around $30 million each and every year in avoided levy costs for councils.

That is exactly the outcome we want—not more landfill, like those opposite, but more recycling. Our approach recognises that regional Queensland needs different solutions. That is why we have given major regional councils greater ongoing cover. It is why Toowoomba and Somerset have moved from the metro levy zone to the regional levy zone. It is why Mount Isa will move to the non-levy zone from 1 July 2027. It is why I think the return of a regional waste and recycling transport assistance program presents such an opportunity—because distance changes the economy. A regional council can have recyclable material ready to go, but if the closest processor is hundreds of kilometres away then moving it can cost more than recycling it is worth. We want to tackle that. In the short term, transport assistance can help get material to existing processing facilities, but there is a longer term opportunity as well—identify the material, aggregate the volumes, demonstrate the demand and start making the business case for new processing capacity in regional Queensland: more material processed closer to home, more investment, more regional jobs and stronger regional recycling industries.

This really comes down to a choice. Those opposite want to look at the levy rate and pretend the rest of the system does not exist. We do not have that luxury. We inherited one of the worst recycling performances in the country so we are working through the whole system: levy settings that make recycling competitive, annual payments to support councils, a better level of ongoing cover for regional councils, resource recovery infrastructure, organics investment, regional transport support, a statewide infrastructure plan and reforms to other parts of the waste system that were allowed to deteriorate under the former Labor government.

We have spent today dealing with one of them: Containers for Change. Queenslanders support that scheme; we support that scheme, which is precisely why we have acted to strengthen its governance, transparency and oversight. That is how we govern. When there is a problem, we do the work. When something needs fixing, we fix it. That is what we are doing with Queensland's broader waste system. Clauses 4 and 7 do something very specific. They provide certainty over the future metropolitan waste levy rates and continue Labor's $10-a-year trajectory that has existed since 2022.

Let me end where I began. Labor introduced the levy, member for Sandgate. Labor's own regulation only prescribed the rates to 2025-26. There was no legislated return to indexation in 2028-29. We are taking a different approach. We are helping councils through annual payments. We are investing in the infrastructure that Labor did not that lets them avoid the levy. It gets Queensland recycling again. Less landfill and more recycling: that is the objective. Those opposite had a decade. Recycling went backwards. We have spent the last two years working methodically to turn it around and we will keep getting on with the job. Clauses 4 and 7 should remain, and this motion should be rejected.

Division: Question put—That the motion be agreed to.

AYES, 31:

ALP, 31—Asif, Bailey, Bourne, Boyd, Bush, Butcher, de Brenni, Dick, Farmer, Furner, Grace, Howard, Linard, Martin, McCallum, McMahon, McMillan, Mellish, Miles, Mullen, Nightingale, O'Shea, Pease, Power, Pugh, Richmond, Russo, Ryan, Scanlon, Smith, Whiting.

NOES, 49:

LNP, 49—Baillie, Barounis, Bates, Bennett, Bleijie, Boothman, Chiesa, Crandon, Crisafulli, Dalton, Dillon, Doolan, Dooley, Field, Frecklington, Gerber, Hatcher, Head, Hutton, Hunt, B. James, T. James, Janetzki, G. Kelly, Kempton, Kirkland, Langbroek, Last, Leahy, Lee, Lister, Mander, Marr, McDonald, Mickelberg, Minnikin, Molhoek, Nicholls, O'Connor, Perrett, Poole, Powell, Purdie, Rowan, Simpson, Stevens, Stoker, Vorster, Young.

Pair: Camm, Enoch.

Resolved in the negative.